

Families

paterfamilias – head of Roman family, who held patria potestas; always **sui iuris** ('his own master')

agnati – people who shared common lineage through males to a common ancestor

cognati – people who were related by blood, through males or females

adfinēs – people who were related by marriage only

patria potestas – power of paterfamilias over his descendants (aka **patria maiestas**, **patrium ius**, **imperium paternum**)

dominica potestas – power of paterfamilias over his property and slaves

manus – authority of paterfamilias over his wife

emancipatio – process by which sons of paterfamilias become heads of new houses

adrogatio – process of one paterfamilias adopting another paterfamilias (had to be approved by pontifices and comitia curiata)

Names*

praenomen – first name;

- Limited number: Aulus (abbreviated "A"), Decimus (D), Gaius (C), Gnaeus (CN), Kaeso (K), Lucius (L), Manius (M'), Marcus (M), Publius (P), Quintus (Q), Servius (SER), Sextus (SEX), Spurius (S), Tiberius (TI), Titus (T)

nomen – second name, family name, tells what gens (clan) to which a person belongs (**nomen gentile**)

cognomen – third name, marks branch of family, typically descriptive of some ancestor: **Naso** = the man with a nose,

Capito = the man with a head; **Cato** = wise, **Cincinnatus** = curly-haired, **Cicero** = chickpea,

Barbatus = bearded

agnomen – additional cognomina after the third name,

- sometimes added after adoption: e.g. C. OctaviusCaepias, after being adopted by C. Iulius Caesar, became C. Iulius Caesar Octavianus (Octavianus is agnomen)
- sometimes added for great achievement: e.g. P. Cornelius Scipio becomes P. Cornelius Scipio Africanus after defeating Hannibal at Zama in Africa in 202 BC.

women's names were most commonly the feminine form of their father's nomen (e.g. C. Julius Caesar's daughter was Julia; M. Tullius Cicero's daughter was Tullia) or could be an adjective reflecting her position among sisters (e.g. Secunda, Tertia, etc.)

Marriage*

confarreatio – most traditional marriage ritual, practiced by the patricians, 10 witnesses required

camillus – boy who carries utensils in a confarreatio (both parents must be alive)

cumerus – small covered basket of utensils carried by a Camillus in the confarreatio

Farreum libum – spelt cake offered to Jupiter during confarreatio

pronuba – matron who brought the bride and groom together during confarreatio

coemptio – marriage ritual among plebeians, represented a fictitious sale of bride for 1 coin (5 witnesses)

usus – common-law marriage practiced among lower classes

contubernium – marriage practiced by slaves

tunica recta – (a.k.a. **tunica regilla**) woman's wedding dress, fastened by the **nodus Herculeanus** (knot of Hercules)

bullā – donated by a bride to the Lares of her father's house the night before her wedding

flammeum – bright orange bridal veil (flame colored)

vittae – ribbons which held six locks of carefully braided hair divided by a spear

Quando tu Gaius, ego Gaia (when/where you are Gaius, I am Gaia) – words spoken at wedding ceremony

May – an unfavorable month for marriages (as well as first half of June)

Sponsalia – a lawfully made promise of future marriage

August 24, October 5, November 8 – unfavorable for marriages because entrance of underworld was open

Children and Education

Genius – guardian spirit that entered the world with boys

Iuno – guardian spirit that entered the world with girls

Dies lustricus – 9th day after birth, when name was given (8th for girls)

primordia - first 8 or 9 days of life before the name was given (called **pupus/pupa** until it was named)

bullae – amulet worn during boyhood, and by triumphing generals to protect against envy

paedagogus – slave who accompanied child to school

grammaticus – schoolteacher

Dependents: Slaves and Clients

meritor – slave dealer

verna – slave who remained the property of his first master

titulus – scroll hung from neck of slave providing information at sale

vilicus – slave who managed a **familia rustica** (group of slaves working on a farm)

peculium – property held by a slave

vicarius – slave owned by another slave

patronus and **cliens** – the patron-client relationship was very pervasive in Rome, with patrons providing resources or power to clients in exchange for their loyalty

sportula – small gift basket given to patrons by their clients during **salutatio**

pilleus – cap worn by slaves during auctions

libertus – freedman

The House and its Furniture*

insula – apartment building

atrium – main reception hall

tablinum – study

compluvium lets rainwater in, **impluvium** is shallow pool which holds it

alae – alcoves on either side of the atrium

peristylum – court with columns surrounding the **hortus** (garden)

vestibulum – entranceway from the street to the atrium

imagines – wax figures of faces of ancestors stored in the alae of the atrium

latrinum – bathroom

triclinium – dining room

cubiculum – bedroom

sella – stool

solium – stiff high-backed chair

mensa – table

lucerna – lamp

candelabra – lamp stand

clepsydra – water clock (marked the hours of the night as well as day and could be used in the house)

solarium – sun-dial (measured the hours of a day by the shadow of a stick or pin)

Dress and Personal Ornaments*

toga virilis— toga of average citizen; also called **toga pura, toga libera**; plain white

toga candida – whitened with chalk, this toga was worn by a candidate for office; also called **toga splendens**

toga praetexta – worn by curule magistrates (consuls, praetors, quaestors), censors, dictators & boys; had a purple border

toga picta – worn by victorious general in triumphal procession; entirely crimson with embroidered gold

toga pulla – dingy toga worn by persons in mourning

lacerna – overcoat wrap put over toga to protect against weather, dust, etc.

paenula – heavier wrap made of wool, to wear outside of toga

soleae – slippers, sandals; had a leather sole

calcei – shoes

petasus – wide-brimmed travelling hat

stola – distinctive dress of a Roman matron

zona – woman's girdle

fullo – drycleaner; often used urine to clean togas

pilleus- cone shaped cap of freedom

indutus – refers to garments that were put on or draped over; chief article was tunic

amictus – refers to garments that were wrapped around

Hadrian – first emperor to wear a beard

Scipio Aemilianus – first Roman to shave daily

Food and Meals*

9 people could dine at a traditional Roman Dinner Party (convivium)

thermopolium- deli

malum persicum (persian apple) – Roman term for peach

malum armeniacum (Armenian apple) – apricot

malum punicum (Phoenician apple) – pomegranate

meta – lower millstone of a grain mill (**mola**); upper stone was **catillus**

amurca – dark bitter oil which flows from first pressing of olives; **oleum** is the edible olive oil

vinum – fermented wine

mulsum – drink made of wine and honey

mulsa – drink made of water and honey

garum - fermented fish sauce

liquamen – a fermented fish sauce similar to garum

glis – doormouse; a delicacy

ientaculum – breakfast

prandium – lunch

cena – chief meal; dinner

gustatio – appetizer

vesperna – light evening meal (sometimes the cena was eaten at midday); also called **merenda**

triclinium – dining room

lectus— couch for dining (three made up the triclinium, 3 diners sat on each couch, 9 total diners)

gustus— appetizers of cena, also called **antecena**

secunda mensa (second table) – dessert

ab ovo usque ad mala – from the egg to the apples (beginning to end of a Roman meal)

convivium – dinner party, also called **symposium**

magister bibendi – “master of drinking”, decides how strong the alcohol will be (**also rex bibendi, arbiter bibendi**)
determined by whoever achieved a Venus throw

Amusements (Games, Races, Baths, etc.)*

Naumachiae were mock naval battles that were performed in a flooded amphitheater

balneae or **thermae**— large Roman baths

apodyterium – dressing room in bath

tepidarium – warm room

caldarium – hot room

frigidarium – cold bath room

unctorium – room for rubbing and anointing with oil

laconicum – steam room

palaestra— exercise grounds; held a **piscina** (cold pool) and a **destrictarium** (room for scraping off sweat and dirt)

strigilis – “scraper” instrument used to scrape oil off skin

tali – knucklebones which were similar to dice (**tesserae**); each tali had four sides (marked 1,3,4,6,); four tali were thrown at once; Venus throw was the best (all showed same number); Vulture throw was the worst (all show different number)

fritillus – box which held tali

Circus Maximus was the most famous chariot racing track

carceres (“prisons”) were starting gates of chariot races

spina(“backbone”) was the dividing fence or wall which stretched across the middle of the circus

metae were the turning posts; same name as millstones because they were shaped like millstones

spatium or **curriculum** – 1 lap in a chariot race

missus – the entire course, which usually consisted of 7 laps

linea alba – chalk starting line used in later times

mappa – napkin dropped by **dator ludorum**(giver of games) to officially start chariot race

ova (eggs) and dolphin figurines were turned to mark each completed lap

factio (pl. **factiones**) was a racing syndicate which competed in the races; there were six different colors: red (**russata**), white (**albata**), blue (**veneta**), green (**prasina**), purple and gold

venationes – hunts for entertainment in the Circus

naumachia – mock naval battle

lanista— trainer of gladiators

rudis— wooden sword used in training gladiators and given to a gladiator if he won his freedom from slavery

Colosseum, or **Flavian Amphitheater**, was dedicated in 80 AD

Porta Libitinensis – gate through which the bodies of dead gladiators exited

Porta Triumphalis – gate through which victor left the circus

Pompey built the first permanent theatre in Rome in 55 BC

ludi scaenici – dramatic stage performances given in the theater

ludi circenses – chariot races and other exhibitions given in a circus

Gladiators

gladiatorial combat came to Rome in 246 BC as part of funeral games (of Brutus Pera)

essedarius - fought from a chariot

tiro - gladiator making his first public appearance

andabata – blindfolded gladiator

dimachaerus – two-sworded gladiator

laquaeatores – gladiator armed with lasso

retiarius – gladiator armed with net and **fuscina** (trident), always fought a **secutor**

Samnite was oldest type gladiators, carried scutum (heavy oblong shield); later called **hoplomachus** (heavy-armed)

Thracian gladiators were lighter armed, carrying a **parma** (small shield) and a curved sword

Murmillones had an ornament like a fish on their helmet

prolusio – mock combat with blunt weapons before actual show

nos morituri te salutamus (“we who are about to die salute you”) was the common greeting spoken by the gladiators to the **editor muneris**(giver of games)

pollice verso (with turned thumb) meant the “thumbs down” signal for one gladiator to kill another

Republican Government

novus homo (“new man”) was someone who didn’t come from a family of aristocratic officeholders

cursus honorum – sequence of public offices a successful politician might ascend: quaestor (treasurer), then praetor (judge), then consul (chief executive). Two new consuls were elected each year.

consuls – chief magistrates; two consuls are elected each year to serve a 1 year term; consuls alternated control each day; one could not be reelected consul until 10 years past; consuls were accompanied by 12 attendants, called **lictors**, who carried the **fasces**. The fasces was a bundle of rods and an axe that symbolized the consuls’ absolute power.

praetors – judges

questors – treasurers

aediles – administrators of games and other public services

censor – two were elected every 5 years; they served 18 months; they revised the citizenship roll by performing a census and could strike out names if people were behaving inappropriately (thus, our term censorship); they also had responsibility over public building projects, like roads and aqueducts

dictator – called in times of severe emergency to assume consular authority; one man was chosen to serve for 6 months

consul suffectus – filled in if both consuls were killed or resigned

Sources of Income and Means of Living; The Roman’s Day

iudex – judge (juror)

argentarius – banker

sutor – shoemaker

tonsor – barber

fullo – drycleaner

nomenclator – person who reminded his boss of the names of people to whom his boss was talking

carnifex/lanius – executioner/butcher

publicanus – tax-collector

pistor – baker

caupo – innkeeper

Burial Places and Funeral Ceremonies

cenotaphium – empty tomb for if a body was lost at sea or otherwise unrecovered

puticuli – graves for the pauper class on the Esquiline Hill

ustrina – private burial plots

Mausoleum of Augustus features tablets of the **Res Gestae**, records of Augustus’ accomplishments

columbaria – underground chambers which stored funeral urns (resembled a dovecote)

libitinarius or **designator** – undertaker

collegia funeraticia – associations for meeting burial expenses of its members

conclamatio – process by which the eldest son bent over body of deceased father calling him by name, to recall to life

laudatio – funeral oration

lectus funebris – funeral couch in atrium on which dead body was placed

rogus – funeral pyre

bustum – grave in which a body was burned

funus acerbum – funeral for young children

funus plebeium – funeral for plebeians

The Roman Religion

flamines – priests of special gods (**Dialis** – **Jupiter**, **Martialis** – **Mars**, **Quirinalis** – **Quirinus**)

Pontifex Maximus – head priest

Salii – dancing priests of Mars (**Salii Collini** – dancing priests of Quirinus)

augures – interpreted the will of the gods by observing bird flight patterns

quindecimviri – priests in charge of the Sybilline Books

fetiales – college of 20 priests responsible for declaration of war

vestal virgins – cared for the sacred fire

Lar Familiaris – protecting spirit of the household

Lares – guardian spirits of the fields; worshipped at crossroads (**compita**)

Magna Mater – Phrygian goddess brought to Rome in 205 BC during the Second Punic War

Isis – goddess brought to Rome from Egypt

Mithras – god brought to Rome from the Eastern Campaigns; patron deity of soldiers

Holidays & Religious Rituals/Festivals:

Compitalia – feast of the crossroads at which the Lares were worshipped

Lemuria – May

Liberalia – March 17th; boy dedicated his **insignia pueritiae** (bullae & toga praetexta) to the Lares

Lupercalia

Lustratio – performance of the lustrum (purification and averting of the evil eye)

mola salsa – mixture of barley flour and salt, sprinkled on the entrails of sacrificial animals

Parilia – Birthday of Rome on April 21st

Robigalia – a red dog is sacrificed to **Robigus** (god of rust) to avert mildew and rust to wheat

Saturnalia – December 17th-23rd; slaves switched roles with their masters

Suovetaurilia – a pig, sheep, and bull were sacrificed; dedicated to Mars as part of the Lustrum

Terminalia – spring festival to consecrate boundary stones between farms

Vinalia Rustica – ewe-lamb sacrificed to Jupiter on August 19th to inaugurate grape-picking season